ARIEL L. JONES

PEOPLE & PROCESS

STRATEGIC ONBOARDING CHECKLIST

Printable worksheet | Plan intentionally. Support people. Track progress.

Use this blank worksheet if you prefer pen and paper. Complete it together with the participant and bring it to your check-ins. Continue on extra paper as needed.

PARTICIPANT NAME

TEAM / DEPARTMENT

POINT OF CONTACT / SUPERVISOR

START DATE

ONBOARDING TRACK ☐ Employee ☐ Volunteer / Ministry ☐ Contractor

DEVELOPMENT TIMELINE ☐ 30 days ☐ 90 days ☐ 4 months ☐ 6 months ☐ 12 months

STRENGTHS & CURRENT CAPACITY

SKILLS GAPS & SUPPORT NEEDED

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PEOPLE & PROCESS

ONBOARDING CHECKLIST

Check off each action as it is completed. Review unfinished items together.

01 Discovery & Alignment

Understand the person before assigning the work.

- [ ] Conduct an introductory conversation about experience and interests.
- [ ] Identify strengths, skills, and contributions.
- [ ] Discuss capacity, availability, and existing commitments.
- [ ] Identify skill gaps, development opportunities, and support needs.
- [ ] Compare strengths and capacity against team needs.
- [ ] Determine a suitable role or assignment.
- [ ] Confirm mutual understanding of expectations.

02 Development & Goal Setting

Create a measurable roadmap for success.

- [ ] Choose an appropriate development timeline.
- [ ] Create a personalized onboarding and development plan.
- [ ] Establish specific, measurable, achievable, relevant, time-bound goals.
- [ ] Define milestones, deliverables, and indicators of success.
- [ ] Clarify responsibilities, performance expectations, and resources.
- [ ] Define accountability measures for future check-ins.
- [ ] Review the plan together and confirm agreement.

03 Systems & Organizational Orientation

Explain how the work gets done.

- [ ] Introduce mission, values, culture, and expectations.
- [ ] Explain the tools, platforms, and systems used in the role.
- [ ] Demonstrate how systems connect and information flows.
- [ ] Explain workflows, approvals, communication, and escalation.
- [ ] Provide appropriate access, SOPs, and training materials.
- [ ] Demonstrate essential tasks and provide guided practice.
- [ ] Confirm where to find help and information.

04 Relationship & Team Integration

Connect the person with their support network.

- [ ] Identify a supervisor, team lead, mentor, or point of contact.
- [ ] Clarify who provides direction, approvals, coaching, and support.
- [ ] Introduce relevant team members and collaborators.
- [ ] Explain how the role connects to broader goals.
- [ ] Establish a meeting cadence with the direct point of contact.
- [ ] Schedule recurring check-ins to build rapport.
- [ ] Confirm preferred communication and response expectations.

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ONBOARDING CHECKLIST

Check off each action as it is completed. Review unfinished items together.

05 Guided Practice & Gradual Delegation

Build competence before full independence.

- [ ] Begin with manageable, low-risk assignments.
- [ ] Demonstrate tasks before independent completion.
- [ ] Provide shadowing, observation, and supported practice.
- [ ] Use repeatable tasks to build system familiarity.
- [ ] Increase responsibility as readiness grows.
- [ ] Provide timely coaching and feedback.
- [ ] Confirm readiness before full project or process handoff.

06 Check-Ins & Performance Development

Keep the plan flexible and accountable.

- [ ] Conduct an initial progress check and formal 30-day review.
- [ ] Review milestones, SMART goals, and open assignments.
- [ ] Assess proficiency, clarity, confidence, and capacity.
- [ ] Invite feedback on the onboarding experience.
- [ ] Identify barriers, process gaps, and training needs.
- [ ] Adjust goals, timelines, responsibilities, or resources.
- [ ] Document decisions, action items, and follow-up dates.

07 Evaluation & Full Integration

Set the person up for continued growth.

- [ ] Assess progress against development goals.
- [ ] Evaluate role fit, engagement, capacity, and competency.
- [ ] Determine readiness for independence or further support.
- [ ] Reassess placement and onboarding approach.
- [ ] Identify growth opportunities and role adjustments.
- [ ] Confirm ongoing accountability and reporting relationships.
- [ ] Transition to the normal review and development cycle.

→ Follow-up actions / support needed

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GOALS & ACCOUNTABILITY

Write up to three goals. Make each one specific, measurable, achievable, relevant and time-bound.

01 PRIMARY GOAL

SMART GOAL: WHAT WILL BE ACHIEVED, AND BY WHEN?

OBJECTIVES / ACTION STEPS

SUCCESS MEASURE / EVIDENCE

TARGET COMPLETION DATE & ACCOUNTABILITY PARTNER

STATUS ☐ Not started ☐ In progress ☐ Needs support ☐ Complete

02 ADDITIONAL GOAL

SMART GOAL: WHAT WILL BE ACHIEVED, AND BY WHEN?

OBJECTIVES / ACTION STEPS

SUCCESS MEASURE / EVIDENCE

TARGET COMPLETION DATE & ACCOUNTABILITY PARTNER

STATUS ☐ Not started ☐ In progress ☐ Needs support ☐ Complete

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GOALS & ONGOING REVIEW

For a year-long plan, break objectives into quarterly milestones and review progress monthly.

03 LONG-TERM GOAL

SMART GOAL: WHAT WILL BE ACHIEVED, AND BY WHEN?

OBJECTIVES / ACTION STEPS

SUCCESS MEASURE / EVIDENCE

TARGET COMPLETION DATE & ACCOUNTABILITY PARTNER

STATUS ☐ Not started ☐ In progress ☐ Needs support ☐ Complete

CHECK-IN FREQUENCY & NEXT CHECK-IN DATE

SUGGESTED FORMAL REVIEWS

30-day plan	Days 7, 14, 30
90-day plan	Days 14, 30, 60, 90
4-month plan	Days 30, 60, 90, 120
6-month plan	Days 30, 60, 90, 120, 180
12-month plan	Days 30, 60, 90, 180, 270, 365

→ CHECK-IN NOTES / NEXT ACTIONS (include owner and due date)

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